

W1 DESIGN OF EXPERIMENTS

Aim: decide whether data can support **causal** claim or only assoc. Units, treatment/exposure, response, comparison group, allocation, measurement.

Causation needs: comparable groups + controlled exposure + plausible mechanism + no major bias/confounding.

Experiment: investigator assigns treatment. Best: random allocation, placebo/control, double-blind, randomised/blinded, randomised control.

Observational: no assignment; can estimate assoc, not alone prove cause. Useful when randomisation unethical/impossible.

Confounder: variable related to exposure and response, not on causal pathway; mixes effects. Eg app use vs final mark: prior WAM affects both. Check causal story: 1. treatment before outcome; 2. identify confounder; 3. list confounders; 4. ask random/control/biased? 5. decide assoc vs cause.

Bias map: selection bias=who enters; consent bias=volunteers differ; observer bias=measurer expectations; survivor/dropout bias=missing worst cases; recall bias=memory differs.

Placebo effect: response to belief of treatment. **Double blind:** subject + investigator unaware. **Historical control:** time may confound.

Simpson: subgroup trends can reverse when pooled if group sizes differ by confounder. Always compare within levels of confounder first.

Claim	Need	Weakness
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Cause	random assign	noncompliance
Effect	representative obs	confounding
Prediction	holdout data	leakage

Exam verbs: identify=state variable; explain=mechanism; critique=why inference fails; improve=design fix.

W2 GRAPHICAL SUMMARIES

Variable types: categorical nominal/ordinal; quantitative discrete/continuous. Choose plot by variable pairing.

Data	Plot	Reads
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1 cat	bar	counts/props
1 quant	hist/box	shape/centre/spread
2 cat	comp box	shape/centre/outliers
2 quant	scatter	trend/form/strength/outliers
2 cat	mosaic/cluster bar	conditional props

Graph read: context -> axes/units -> overall pattern -> exceptions -> relevant comparison -> cautious conclusion.

Histogram: bin width changes impression; use for shape. Left-closed right-open $[a, b)$ common. Frequency counts in interval; density area if scaled.

Boxplot: median, Q1, Q3, IQR, whiskers to non-outliers, outlier if $< Q1 - 1.5 IQR$ or $> Q3 + 1.5 IQR$. Cannot read mean/SD exactly. **Scatter:** direction (+/-), form (linear/curved), strength, outliers/clusters. **Correlation only linear.**

Do not infer causation from plot; ask design. Overplotting: use alpha, jitter, faceting; alpha does not fit model.

ggplot: use point/transparency, colour/facet by group, and clear axes; mapping legend aes varies by data.

Bad graphs: truncated axis exaggerates; dual axes confuse; pie poor for many cats; counts hide group size; stacked bars hide conditional denominator.

W3 NUMERICAL SUMMARIES

Centre: mean $\bar{x} = \sum x_i/n$ sensitive to outliers; median robust. Use median for skewed/outliers.

Spread: $s = \sqrt{\sum (x_i - \bar{x})^2 / (n - 1)}$ sample SD; $IQR = Q3 - Q1$ robust; range=max-min.

Shift/scale: if $Y = a + bX$, mean_Y = $a + b$ mean_X, SD_Y = $|b|$ SD_X, IQR_Y = $|b|$ IQR_X; adding constant changes centre not spread.

Percentile: pth percentile has about p% below. Five-number summary: min, Q1, med, Q3, max.

Skew: mean > median often right-skew; mean < median left-skew. Outliers pull mean and SD more than median/IQR. Compare groups: centre difference + spread + overlap + skew/outliers + sample size + practical context.

Correlation: r in $[-1, 1]$, unitless, unaffected by adding constants or multiplying by positive constant; sign flips if one variable multiplied by negative.

$r = 0$ means no linear assoc, not no relationship. $r = .95$ does not mean 95% points on a line.

Transform	Mean	SD
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$x + c$	$+c$	$ c $
$c \times x$	$\times c$	$\times c $
$a + bx$	$a + b\bar{x}$	$ b s$

Recall trap: every value +100 -> mean/median +100; IQR/SD/correlation unchanged.

W4 NORMAL MODEL

Normal: $X \sim N(\mu, \sigma^2)$, bell-shaped, symmetric. Standardise $Z = (X - \mu)/\sigma$.

$P(a < X \leq b) = \Phi((b - \mu)/\sigma) - \Phi((a - \mu)/\sigma)$; R: 'pnorm(b,mu,sd), pnorm(a,mu,sd)'.

68-95-99.7: within 1,2,3 SD approx .68, .95, .997. Symmetry: $P(Z > z) = 1 - \Phi(z) = \Phi(-z)$.

qnorm: inverse probability/cutoff. 'qnorm(.975,mu,sd)' = upper 2.5% cutoff for two-sided 95%.

Measurement model: reading = exact + bias + random error. Repeated avg reduces random error SE $\propto 1/\sqrt{n}$ but not bias.

Averaging fixes noise, not systematic bias. Calibration fixes bias. More repeated readings shrink random SD of mean by $\sqrt{n}$.

Approx normal: plausible for many biological measurement errors and sample averages; poor for bounded, highly skewed, tiny n , mixture distributions.

Task	R	Avoid
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prob below pnorm(x,mu,sd)	qnorm	
prob above 1-pnorm(x,mu,sd)	sd< as sd	
qnorm(p,mu,sd)	pnorm	

Unit conversion: if lb=2.205kg, both mean and SD multiply by 2.205; probabilities may compute on either scale after converting cutoff.

W5 LINEAR MODEL

SLR: $\hat{y} = a + bx$, slope = expected change in y per 1-unit x ; intercept at $x = 0$ may be meaningless.

Prediction at x_0 : plug into fitted line. Residual $e = y - \hat{y}$. RMS error $\approx$ typical vertical prediction error in y units.

Least squares: line minimises sum squared residuals; residuals average 0 when intercept included.

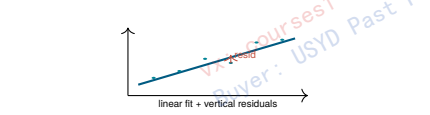
R output: coefficients table gives intercept and slope. Formula 'lm(y ~ x)'

predicts $\hat{y} = \beta_0 + \beta_1 x$.

Model checks: scatter roughly linear; residuals random around 0; no U-shape/funnel/extreme leverage; avoid extrapolation outside observed x .

R^2 is proportion of response variance explained in sample; high train R^2 does not guarantee low test error.

Correlation-slope link: $b = r(s_y/s_x)$. Correlation has no units; slope has units y/x . Slope comparisons across groups do not imply correlation comparison.



W6 UNDERSTANDING CHANCE

Chance: long-run freq, not guarantee in short run. Independence: knowing A gives no info about B; mutually exclusive events usually not independent unless one has prob 0.

Addition: $P(A \cup B) = P(A) + P(B) - P(A \cap B)$. Multiplication for independent: $P(A \cap B) = P(A)P(B)$.

Counting: with replacement independent; without replacement dependent but symmetry can simplify (5th card queen prob 1/52).

Binomial: fixed n , independent trials, same p , count successes.

$P(X = k) = \binom{n}{k} p^k (1 - p)^{n-k}$, $E = np$, $SD = \sqrt{np(1 - p)}$.

Box model: tickets represent possible outcomes; draws model randomness. Sum of draws: $EV = n\mu_{box}$, $SE = \sqrt{n} SD_{box}$. Avg: $EV = \mu_{box}$, $SE = SD_{box}/\sqrt{n}$.

For 0/1 box with proportion p : mean= p , $SD = \sqrt{p(1 - p)}$ approx; under $p = .5$, $SD = .5$.

Build box: define one draw outcome -> tickets -> number of draws -> statistic sum/avg/count/prob -> EV/SE -> compare observed.

Trap: SE for sum grows as $\sqrt{n}$; SE for average/proportion shrinks as $1/\sqrt{n}$.

W7 PROJECT WEEK

EDA cycle: question -> data provenance -> clean/types -> summaries/plots -> anomalies -> model/test if justified -> communicate limitations.

Client report = answer the practical question, not list every plot. Use context, units, effect size, uncertainty, and design caveats.

Data quality: missingness, impossible values, duplicates, coding choices, outliers, inconsistent units, sampling frame, privacy/re-identification.

Reproducible workflow: import -> wrangle -> visualise -> summarise -> model/test -> interpret -> cite sources; scripts + seeds + clear variable definitions.

Ethics: privacy, consent, harm, fairness, transparency. Removing names not enough if rare combinations re-identify people. If use: disclosed in open tasks only with acknowledgement; never fabricate data/output; verify code and claims; secure exams prohibit AI.

Problem	Symptom	Fix
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leakage	test info in train	split first
bad denominator	wrong percent	state base
confounding	causal overclaim	stratify/design
p-hacking	many unplanned tests	pre-specify

Presentation: claim -> evidence -> caveat -> action. If plot and number conflict, inspect definitions and subplots before choosing.

W8 BOX MODEL/CLT

CLT: for large n , distribution of sums/averages is approx normal even if box not normal, if independent draws and no single huge-ticket domination.

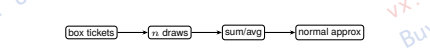
Observed statistic -> expected under model -> $SE = z(\text{obs}-EV)/SE$ -> p-value/tail area.

Sample avg: $\bar{X} \approx N(\mu, \sigma^2/n)$ for large n . **Sample sum:** $S \approx N(n\mu, n\sigma^2)$.

Finite population: without replacement from small population lowers SE via finite population correction; DATA1001 often uses

Simulation: repeat random experiment many times; empirical histogram approximates sampling distribution. More reps reduce simulation noise, not model bias.

A 95% normal approx interval for statistic: estimate $\pm 2SE$ rough; exact interpretation depends on statistic and sampling.



Diagnostic: if n small and box very skewed/binary rare event, prefer exact binomial/simulation over normal approx.

W9 SAMPLE SURVEYS

Population: group of interest. Sample: observed subset. Parameter fixed unknown; statistic random.

Sampling: SRS gives every unit equal chance; stratified samples within key groups; cluster samples groups; convenience/volunteer samples risk bias.

Bias does not shrink with larger n ; random error shrinks as $1/\sqrt{n}$. A huge biased sample can be precisely wrong.

Sample proportion: $\hat{p}$ estimates p ; SE approx $\sqrt{p(1 - p)/n}$ or plug-in $\sqrt{\hat{p}(1 - \hat{p})/n}$. Max SE at $p = .5$.

Survey critique: sampling frame -> selection method -> nonresponse -> wording/order -> mode -> weighting -> uncertainty.

Question wording: leading/loading/double-barrelled questions shift responses. Eg 'stop wasting money...' invalid neutral wording. **Margin of error:** rough 95% MOE $\approx 2SE$. For percentages, convert proportions carefully.

Error	From	Fixed by
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random selection	chance sample mix	larger n
nonresponse	bad frame	better design
measurement	who replies	follow-up/weights
	bad question/tool	redesign

External validity: even perfect random sample only generalises to the sampled population/frame.

W10 HYPOTHESIS TESTING

Logic: assume H_0 , compute how surprising data are; p-value = probability of statistic at least as extreme as observed under H_0 .

Small p -> evidence against H_0 ; large p -> data consistent with H_0 , not proof H_0 true.

Test recipe: 1 parameter; $2 H_0, H_1$ before seeing data; 3 test statistic; 4 reference distribution/simulation; 5 p-value; 6 conclusion in context.

Alternatives: two-sided $\neq$; one-sided $>$ or $<$. Direction must be pre-specified; if observed direction opposite one-sided alternative, p large. **Type I:** reject H_0 , prob α . **Type II:** fail reject false H_0 .

Power = $1 - \beta$.

Multiple tests inflate false positives: expected false rejections $m\alpha$ if all null true.

Test statistic: signal/noise, e.g. $(\hat{\theta} - \theta_0)/SE$. Larger absolute value often stronger evidence.

P-value myths: not $P(H_0 \text{ true})$; not effect size; not probability result due to chance; not reproducibility guarantee.

W11 TESTS FOR A MEAN

One-sample mean: $H_0: \mu = \mu_0$; statistic $t = (\bar{x} - \mu_0)/(s/\sqrt{n})$, df= $n-1$ if normal/approx appropriate.

R: 't.test(x,mu=mu0)' default two-sided; CI containing μ_0 corresponds fail reject at matching two-sided α .

Assumptions: independent sample, quantitative response, no extreme skew/outliers for small n ; larger n uses CLT. Interpret CI: plausible values for population mean under method; not interval containing 95% of observations.

One-sided from two-sided: if symmetric and effect in predicted direction, one-sided p approx half two-sided p; if wrong direction, p approx 1-half. Effect size matters: statistical significance can be practically tiny with large n ; non-significance may be low power.

Output	Read	Conclusion
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p=.024	< .05	reject at 5%
CI [48.5, 52.7]	contains 50	fail reject 5%
t=2.1	below null	sample mean lower

No calculators?: focus on form, direction, compare p to alpha, and contextual wording.

W12 TESTS FOR RELATIONSHIP

Proportion test: binary outcome, $H_0: p = p_0$; under $p_0 = .5$, $SE = .5/\sqrt{n}$ for p . Taste-test 'no preference' $p = .5$.

Chi-square GOF: compare observed counts to expected counts. $\chi^2 = \sum (O - E)^2 / E$, df=categories-1-adjusted constraints; large values reject.

Chi-square independence: two categorical variables; expected E_{ij} = row total $\times$ col total / n ; df=($r-1$)($c-1$).

Regression relationship: test slope/correlation vs 0; interpret slope, p-value, CI, residual diagnostics. Association not causation unless design supports.

For relationships: state variables, direction, strength/effect, uncertainty, design limitation.

Choose test: binary one sample -> prop/binomial; one quantitative mean -> t; many category counts -> chi-square; two quantitative relationship -> regression.

Common fall traps: wrong denominator for percentages; using n for probability; accepting null; ignoring confounder; comparing training R^2 to test error; assuming larger sample removes bias.

Question	Method	Key output
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mean=?	t.test	t,df,p,CI
prop=?	prop/binombox	z,p
fair die?	chi-square GOF	χ^2 ,df
x-y linear/lm?	lm	slope/r, resid

MICRO EXAMPLES

1) Box {0, 1, 1, 3, 5}, 100 draws sum: mean ticket 2, $EV = 200$, $SE = 10SD(b_{box})$.

2) $X \sim N(12, 3^2)$, $P(10 < X \leq 14) = \text{pnorm}(14,12,3) - \text{pnorm}(10,12,3)$.

3) 'lm(mark sleep)' coef (.48, 3.2): predicted mark at sleep=7 is 70.4; do not call causal if pnorm not randomised.

$p = .78$: little evidence against H_0 ; never say 78% chance null true.

R OUTPUT DECODER

R line	Means	Exam response
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'summary(x)'	Min,Q1,Med,Mean,Q3,Max	shape/centre/outliers
'sd(x)'	sample SD	typical distance
'cor(x,y)'	linear assoc	sign/strength only
'lm(x)'	fit line	predicted/read slope
't.test'	mean test + CI	compare p/CI
'chisq.test'	count table test	large stat rejects

Reading code: identify data object, variable names, grouping formula 'y group', function purpose, arguments, output scale.

Formula syntax: response predictor; in boxplot/lm/test, left side is quantitative response, right side group/predictor.

Common R traps: 'pnorm' gives area, 'qnorm' gives cutoff; 'sd=3' not variance 9 ; 'alpha' in ggplot is transparency; 'df' for t is not sample size. When R output and story disagree, trust definitions/variables first: units, filtering, missing data, denominator, and whether values are proportions or percentages.

TEST CHOICE MAP

Data	Parameter	Null	Method
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one mean	μ	$\mu = 0$	t/box
paired diff	μ_d	$\mu_d = 0$	t on diff
one prop	p	$p = p_0$	prop/binom/box
counts k cats	p_k	all indep	chi GOF
two cats	assoc	indep	chi indep
two quant	slope/r	0	lm/cor

Conclusion template: Since $p < \alpha$, [reject/fail reject] H_0 . The data

[provide/do not provide] evidence that [contextual alternative].

Fail to reject = insufficient evidence; never 'accept', 'prove equal', or 'no effect exists'.

Tail choice: 'different/changed/associated' -> two-sided; 'greater/increase/higher' -> upper; 'less/decrease/lower' -> lower. Must choose before data.

Test stat sign: positive if observed estimate above null; negative if below. Two-sided uses magnitude; one-sided cares direction.

Critical value: reject if statistic beyond critical region; p-value method equivalent when same α and same tail.

STUDY DESIGN FIXES

Weak study	Main risk	Better design
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self-select app	confounding	random assign app
historical control	time trend	concurrent control
open label	placebo/observer	double blind
convenience pop	selection	SRS/strata
high dropout	attrition	intention-to-treat
many outcomes	p-hack	pre-register

Blocking/stratifying: compare or randomise within known confounder groups to improve balance; still only controls measured factors.

Randomisation: balances known/unknown confounders on average; individuals in groups can still be imbalanced, esp small n .

A representative sample helps estimate population; random assignment helps causal inference. They solve different problems.

Causal critique paragraph: "The groups differ in ..., which may affect both ... and ... Therefore the observed difference could be due to ..., not the treatment."

Reverse causation: high marks may cause app engagement; health may affect exercise; disease symptoms may cause medication use.

GRAPH/NUMBER PITFALLS

Anscombe quartet: same mean/SD/correlation/regression can hide different shapes; always plot.

Ecological fallacy: group-level association may not hold for individuals. Aggregation bias: combined data hides subgroup structure.

Percent comparison needs same denominator. "More students" counts can conflict with "higher rate" percentages.

Evidence	Stronger read	Caution
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med far below mean	right skew	outlier?
wide IQR	variable middle 50%	units matter
high +	linear trend	outliers/curve
U residuals	misleading curvature	transform/add term
funnel residuals	nonconstant var	predictions uneven

Outlier handling: do not delete just because inconvenient. Ask measurement error? valid rare case? analysis sensitivity? effect on mean/slope?

Standardisation: $z = (x - \bar{x})/s$ converts to SD units; useful across scales; does not make non-normal data normal.

BOX MODEL DETAILS

Tickets: encode null distribution, not observed sample unless using bootstrap-like resampling. For a fair die, box {1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6}; for no preference, box {0, 1} with equal tickets.

Observed count k out of n : observed prob $\hat{p} = k/n$; null EV count $n p_0$; null SE count $\sqrt{n} \sqrt{p_0(1 - p_0)}$.

Simulation p : simulate many stats under H_0 ; p = fraction at least as extreme as observed. Include both tails for two-sided.

Exact vs approx: binomial exact for small binary; normal/CLT for large; if use, square needs expected counts not too tiny.

Continuity intuition: count is discrete; normal is continuous, so approximations can be rough near boundaries or small counts. **SE is about repeated sampling variability, not variability among individual observations.**

REGRESSION EXTRAS

Leverage: unusual x can strongly affect line. **Influential:** removing point changes fit a lot.

Prediction vs explanation: a model may predict well without causal explanation; causal explanation needs design/theory.

Do not extrapolate: line fit for observed x range may fall outside it. Interpret often meaningless if $x = 0$ outside data.

Quantity	Units	Meaning
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residual	y	actual-pred
RMS err	y	typical error
r	none	linear strength
R^2	percent	in-sample varia